

Untold stories

The 6,400 female Vietnam veterans, who experienced an unusually high degree of trauma from the war, were often ignored and their experiences trivialized. Nurses' stories dominate the conversation about female Vietnam veterans, while those who served in other capacities have found their experiences largely ignored; the Women's Army Corps records were lost, and remain so despite veterans' calls to find them. Some female veterans have expressed their struggle to see themselves in the Vietnam Women's Memorial, which depicts an Army nurse tending to a wounded soldier.

The triumphant homecoming of prisoners of war (POWs) caught the nation's attention, but thousands of men missing in action (MIA) did not come home. Families grieved as the government appeared to give up on these men, treating them like inconvenient remnants standing in the way of new relations with former foes.